

The Market of Mixed-Up Magic

The Floating Isles are islands adrift in a calm sky, in a realm where magic only ever helps: it grows, it heals, it changes one thing into another, and it lets you speak with animals and objects. It never harms. On the home island, the House of the Little Mages sits at the highest point, where young mages learn their first spells, and the city where the families live spreads below. Inside the school grounds lies the Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island. Here nobody loses; you find your way by being clever and kind.



The Market of Mixed-Up Magic

Read aloud, or let an older child read. Stop often to let everyone share their ideas. There are no wrong answers here, only new ones to try.

Before you begin

It is market day on the home island. The Market Row is bright and busy. Every stall is full: warm bread, ripe fruit, neat shoes, and bright toys.

Then there is a small flash and a soft pop. All at once, everything is in the wrong place. The baker is holding a pair of boots. The cobbler is holding a kite. The fruit and the toys have swapped stalls. Nobody can find their things.

You are little mages, and you can put this right. "Let us untangle the market," you say together.

What is your mage name? Which magic do you choose: Light, Grow, Change, or Voice?

Stop 1: The Muddled Stalls

You walk along the row. Every object sits in the wrong place, looking a little lost. A pair of boots blinks up at you from the bread stall.

The Mist Cat pads over and sits beside you, ready to help.

How can you find out where everything belongs? Could you ask the objects themselves? Try something and see.

When the objects tell you their homes, you start carrying them back. The easy ones are soon in the right place again. But a few are still in a muddle.

Stop 2: The Memory of the Market

To finish, you need to remember how the market looked before the mix-up: who had what, and where. That is hard, because everything has moved.

A Talking Flower in a pot leans close and hums the market in order, stall by stall, to help you remember.

Can you remember which stall had the bread, the fruit, the shoes and the toys? Match each thing back to the right stall.

When you set each thing where it began, more of the market is happy again. Only one tangle is left, and it is a tricky one.

Stop 3: The Last Swap

Three stalls are still wrong, and they are tangled in a loop. The baker has boots. The cobbler has a kite. The toymaker has bread. Each one is holding the wrong thing, and to fix it you must work out who should pass what to whom.

Who gives their thing to whom, so that everyone ends up with the right one? Talk it through together.

When you untangle the last swap, the whole Market Row cheers. Every stall is right again. But where did the mix-up come from in the first place?

Pip the New Mage

Behind a quiet stall you find a young mage curled up small. Their name is Pip, and it is their very first day. Pip tried a Change spell to help, but it went wonky and muddled the whole market. Pip was so worried, and so shy, that they hid away.

There is no telling-off here. Everyone makes mistakes, especially on a first day.

What do you say to Pip? How can you show them that it is alright, and that nobody fixed this alone, you fixed it together?

When you tell Pip kindly that all is well, they peek out and smile. With one careful Change, Pip sets the very last thing right, and the whole market claps. Pip stands a little taller.

You did it together. You were clever, and you were kind. Well done.

The Story in Pictures



A row of market stalls with goods swapped around, two young mages asking a pair of boots where they belong amid soft magic sparkles.



Two young mages returning goods to the right stalls, loaves and toys floating back, the Mist Cat beside them helping them remember.



A shy young apprentice mage peeking from behind a stall while two young mages reassure them with kind smiles, the friendly market all around.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Notes

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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